the international order. This extends to both competitors and, on some issues, even partners.

India will therefore need to accelerate its development trajectory and strengthen its security, compete more effectively in its immediate and broader region, and shape international institutions and norms in its favour on matters concerning war and peace, economic exchange, and governance the global commons. Addressing these challenges will require taking diverse steps over the coming years and decades. But, to start, foreign policy will have to begin at home.

Background: The Limits of Globalization

The objective of accelerating India's domestic development to increase the fundamentals of its power can be premised on four propositions. One, India's political and economic circumstances are unique. Two, India derives considerable advantages from international partnerships. Three, liberalization alone will not address all of India's development challenges. Four, India must invest in the foundations of national power: security and prosperity. Each of these deserves a more detailed explanation.

India's political and economic circumstances are unique. At Independence, and for decades that followed, India was incredibly large, poor, diverse, and democratic. Taken together, these qualities presented it with conditions that almost no other country had to confront as it sought to modernize and accelerate its domestic development. For all its gains in the decades since, India is still a developing country. Absolute poverty may have sharply declined, but Indian policymakers still place priority on development needs and objectives, including affordable health and housing solutions, food and energy security, basic education, the efficient delivery of public goods, and employment for a large workforce transitioning out of agriculture. Meeting these objectives remains crucially important and still heavily informs India's policies concerning international trade, its desire to attract foreign investment, its net outward migration, and its approaches to climate change and the energy transition.